



Executive Summary 2024-25

And Strategic Plan 2025-26

Exciting Vision for Healthy Community Lifespaces: Promoting Health and Equity

Our Vision: At Healthy Community Lifespaces (HCL), we envision a world where every individual has the opportunity to thrive in a balanced, inclusive, and healthy environment. We believe that by empowering communities and fostering diverse talents, we can create sustainable Lifespaces that support holistic well-being for all.

Our Mission:

To promote equity and foster inclusive, healthy environments through innovative strategies and education, empowering individuals and communities to make evidence-based choices for healthier Lifespaces. Focus on student on and community empowerment

Our Values:

- **Empowerment:** We believe in uplifting communities and individuals, providing them with the resources to create sustainable, healthy Lifespaces. Focusing on student on and community empowerment to provide innovation in promoting health.
 - **Diversity:** We celebrate the unique talents and abilities of every individual, recognizing that diverse perspectives strengthen our communities.
 - **Health & Wellness:** We are committed to creating environments that support holistic health including physical, mental, and emotional well-being for all.
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What Are Lifespaces?

Lifespaces encompass the physical, social, and psychological environments of individuals. This includes their homes, communities, and the surrounding factors that influence their lives. By understanding the interplay of these elements, we aim to create supportive networks that enhance well-being and promote healthy behaviors.

Current Partnerships:



Healthy Community Lifespaces 2024–2025 Report & 2025–2026 Goals

State-Level Engagement

Current Work (2023–2024)

Our Director actively participates in workgroups for the Pennsylvania State Health Improvement Plan (PA SHIP) and ENGAGE PEH, fostering community collaboration through both virtual and in-person meetings.

Objective

To align efforts across state agencies, local health departments, and community organizations in developing a unified, evidence-based approach to health improvement.

Summary

Healthy Community Lifespaces (HCL) contributes to ongoing dialogues with stakeholders, including the Pennsylvania Department of Health (PDH), Department of Education (PDE), healthcare providers, and other community organizations. These efforts have led to:

- Innovative strategies addressing critical health issues
- Enhanced access to care
- Advocacy for underserved populations
- Sharing of data-driven insights and resources

HCL shared PDE's updated physical education and health standards with local school districts and organizations. We also helped circulate evidence-based articles to improve equity in youth programs. PDE has actively supported HCL's student contests.

Goal (2025–2026)

Continue quarterly engagement in ENGAGE HPE and PA SHIP Goal 2.1 workgroups. Maintain communication with partners to promote HCL student contests and support community wellness.



Caregiver & Recovery Home Initiatives

Caregiver Training Program

Objective

Develop a comprehensive wellness training program to enhance caregiver skills and well-being.

Focus Areas:

- Wellness Promotion: Understanding the holistic needs of caregivers and care recipients
- Confidence in Abilities: Encouraging physical activity and communication with healthcare providers
- Sensory Regulation: Activities supporting sensory needs and comfort
- Outdoor Mental Health Benefits: Integrating nature into daily routines
- Nutrition Awareness: Promoting balanced meals and healthy eating

Summary (2024–2025)

Webinar and virtual training materials are in development.

Thistle Hills Program

Objective

Promote healthy cooking and gardening for residents of Thistle Hills recovery home.

Current Work (2024–2025)

- Spring cooking session conducted
- Hosted a “Days for Girls” volunteer opportunity
- Scheduled summer and fall cooking classes
- Another partner nonprofit began regular gardening visit

Goals (2025–2026)

Increase seasonal cooking sessions.



Children's Garden Program – Upper Merion Community Garden

Objective

Educate children (including charter, cyber, and homeschooled students) about nutrition and nature.

Program Highlights:

- Introduce vegetable nutrition via hands-on gardening and “vegetable bingo”
- Encourage outdoor activity for mental wellness
- Build lifelong healthy habits through exposure to fresh produce

Summary (2024–2025)

- Fall harvest and tasting event held for 10 children
- Spring planting had low attendance due to sports conflicts; age limits adjusted
- Teen coordinator added
- Survey results showed positive feedback and learning

Goals (2025–2026)

- Host two sessions (spring and fall)
- Expand age range to include Pre-K
- Promote more actively in local schools

Teen Health Leadership Program

Objective

Engage teens in promoting community health through creative leadership roles.



Components:

- Teen Blog: Share research, experiences, and peer health advice
- Social Media Management: Operate HCL Instagram, promote student contests
- Teen-Led Initiatives: Health food drives and community outreach

Summary (2024–2025)

- new members in teen group
- Participated in international festival
- Launched healthy food donation project with local food bank
- Active Instagram account launched

Goals (2025–2026)

- Finalize and support teen-led project goals
 - Maintain and grow blog and Instagram presence
 - Expand healthy food drive initiative
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Student Health Contests

Objective

Encourage student involvement in statewide health initiatives.

Key Activities:

- Select PA's official state fruit and vegetable
- Promote healthy eating at athletic events
- Support Farm to School and PA SHIP objectives

Summary (2024–2025)

- Partnered with HABI and Montgomery County Public Health to distribute helmets



- Provided funding for winners to engage in physical activity
- Senator Comitta introduced legislation to designate the apple as the state fruit

Goals (2025–2026)

- Continue the contest until official vegetable is designated
- Promote state fruit legislation

Student Contest Info

School Wellness & Health Equity

Objective

Support schools in implementing wellness plans and promoting inclusive health environments.

Summary (2024–2025)

- **Worked with Upper Merion Area School District to engage students in wellness planning**
- Advocated for Safe Routes to School (SRTS)
- Conducted Ruby Bridges Walk to School Day (Nov. 14, 2024)
- Hosted National Walk to School Day in May
- Continued walking school bus with 4 students
- Advocated for improved safety measures around school grounds

Goals (2025–2026)

- Continue SRTS advocacy and wellness policy implementation
 - Expand access to school facilities for public use
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Health Equity in Community Wellness Plans

Objective

Support agencies, athletic events, and community spaces in adopting health equity-focused wellness policies.

Summary (2024–2025)

- Advocated with Easterseals to update preschool wellness policies and address choking hazards
 - Promoted fruit over candy at major events like the International Festival
 - Shared monthly evidence-based articles on health topics
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Newsletter Initiative

Summary (2024–2025)

- Created email list
- Sent newsletters quarterly beginning December

Goals (2025–2026)

- Maintain quarterly newsletter distribution
 - Grow audience through school and community outreach
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University & Library Partnerships

University Partnerships:

- Summary (2024–2025): No university partnerships formed due to budget cuts
- Goals (2025–2026): Renew outreach and explore new collaborations focused on health equity

Library Partnerships:



- Promoted “Let’s Move in the Library” and Storywalks
- Expanded outreach to Ephrata Library
- Whitpain and Wissahickon collaborations on hold

Fundraising & Sponsorships

Summary (2024–2025)

- Launched “Fruit Basket” initiative
- Three businesses replaced candy with fruit:
 - Experience Chiropractic
 - Lifesound Hearing
 - Citadel Credit Union (Trooper branch)
- Explored SPARK platform for sponsorships
- Zeffy used for individual contributions

Goals (2025–2026)

- Maintain and expand fruit basket initiative
- Continue pursuing grants and funding opportunities

Future Project: Launch HCL Podcast

Title Ideas:

- *Nourish & Protect*
- *Protect & Nourish: Building Healthy Communities*
- *The Lifespace Podcast: Where Health Meets Community*

Join Us!

We invite individuals, organizations, and communities to join us in our mission to create healthier Lifespaces. Together, we can build a more equitable future where everyone has the opportunity to thrive. Let’s empower each other and make a lasting difference!